

AQUILA TAKES FLIGHT

Facebook's project Aquila is aimed towards designing, building and launching a high-altitude solar-powered airplane that can deliver internet access around the world. Here's the story of events of the D-Day; Aquila's first full scale test flight!
<http://dgit.in/AquilaTest>

**WINDOWS 10 ANNIVERSARY UPDATE**

The Windows 10 Anniversary Update is finally live and there's a certain reason it is being called the biggest update for Windows 10 yet. Check out these top add-ons with the anniversary update including logging into apps with your face!
<http://dgit.in/Win10AnniUp>

**SOFTWARE INNOVATIONS**

After almost a decade of waging war over the hardware, isn't it high time that these hardware innovations drive the software innovations further, be it in the face of Artificial Intelligence or even Virtual Reality, which not only target millions, but billions!
<http://dgit.in/SoftInno>

**ULTIMATE GEOFILTER GUIDE**

Snapchat has been expanding the on-demand Geofilters lately and the only difference between these on-demand Geofilters and the traditional ones offered by Snapchat is that anyone can make one. Here's the ultimate guide to Snapchat's Geofilter, including making one yourself.
<http://dgit.in/SnapGeoF>



Understanding Facebook's Express Wi-Fi service

Facebook's Wi-Fi is not free, which will hopefully keep it from being a walled garden.

– By Prasad Banerjee

After TRAI's ban on Free Basics, Facebook is trying once again to get Indian users on to its social network. This time, the company is testing a service called Express Wi-Fi, in partnership with "multiple local ISP partners" in India. This ideally means that Facebook is providing services that will allow service providers to bring Internet to rural areas in India, through public hotspots. Not much is clear about how the Express Wi-Fi service will work, though.

What is Express Wi-Fi?

Interestingly, the Express Wi-Fi website mentions the company's Free Basics platform. The website has multiple promo-



tional messages for the service, but at the bottom, Facebook asks you to "add your website to Free Basics". There is no clarity on how Free Basics figures into the Express Wi-Fi service, though. The company has

run a pilot program with a local state-run telecom across 125 rural hotspots.

Having said that, reports indicate that the Wi-Fi will be 'cheap', but not free, which makes it difficult to present a walled garden like Free Basics. Facebook is most likely betting that users accessing internet through its Wi-Fi will eventually be led to the social network as well. "When people are able to purchase fast, affordable and reliable internet, they're able to explore the range of information it has to offer including news, education, health, job postings, entertainment, and communication tools like Facebook," the website says. There is, of course, some revenue being generated from the service, as users will have to purchase access to the hotspots through their data packages. So, it is possible that Facebook will get a cut of these revenues.

Facebook isn't the first to try and "connect" people from rural areas in India. The company's chief competition in this case is Google, which started providing Wi-Fi networks in Indian railway stations some time ago.

How does Facebook earn?

While one may question why users would choose Facebook's paid service over Google's free one, it is worth noting that the area of approach isn't the same.



Mumbai Central station was the first to get Google's free Wi-Fi service

Google's Wi-Fi is currently confined to 23 railway stations and will expand to others as well, Facebook is presumably looking to pull closer to rural areas, with hotspots close to rural homes.

The likely play from both the companies is user data. Both companies can charge advertisers for exclusive and targeted advertisements on their Wi-Fi networks, thereby generating enough revenues to keep the services running.

An investment

Both Facebook and Google have made an investment in the Indian market with respective Wi-Fi services. The end-game for both is to get the millions of users on to their platforms and hence end up earning from them. **1**

Read the full story here: <http://dgit.in/XpressWiFi>